so small sums as three or four roubles (eight to eleven shillings), but with some unfavourable circumstance attending the debt, so that persons are not immediately permitted to discharge them. They are allowed from government twenty copecks (6½d.) a day, eight of which are for their diet, clothes, etc., and the other twelve for their creditors, till the whole debt is paid off. These were also in irons and work with the criminals at the public works.

"In other rooms were three hundred and forty-five prisoners. In a small inner room, I found two Russians, sent hither about four years ago: they had a guard at the door, and had never been out of the room, and are heavily ironed both hands and feet: they are never spoken to, nor is their crime known. They had suffered the punishment of the knoot (which in my former publication I have described), and had a piece cut out of each nostril, and the mark on the cheeks, which is the signature of their condemnation for life. I saw several others thus marked for murder or other very capital crimes. All the prisoners were in irons, and work in summer from four to eleven, and from one to eight, unless sick, which the surgeon comes every morning to examine. There were three hundred and eleven out, the day I was there, hewing timber, driving piles, wheeling and carrying the stones for a fine mole sixty-five feet wide and half a mile long, on which they had been employed for six years: their allowance is six copecks a day, for which all their clothing and provision is found; the former bad, the latter very indifferent. As to religious instruction, once a year only they go to the chapel in the citadel; and on the other Sundays they amuse themselves, or make shoes, etc. About a fortnight before my visit, the head knoot-master was brought from St. Petersburgh, who being with the other two knoot-masters at a public-house, they happened to quarrel: he immediately struck off the head of one of them; the other seeming to resent it he dexterously decapitated him also. As no crime, not even that crying one of shedding blood, is punished in Russia with death, this man received two hundred and seventy strokes of the knoot, the executioner from Moscow being brought for that purpose; and being condemned for life, was marked as before described. Here he met several of his former acquaintance to whom he had given the knoot, and on being asked in how many strokes he could kill a man, he said, if a strong man, he could in five and twenty, but if not strong, in twenty strokes."

[From "*Account of Lazarettos*," *second edition, appendix*.]

POLAND

WARSAW. In Warsaw, at the town-house, in September 1781, there were twenty-six men and eight women, crowded into three rooms on the ground-floor for confining debtors; the reason of which was, that the prison was repairing. Down several steps were eight new dungeons for criminals, four on each side a passage only six feet wide. There was no gaoler, the prison being guarded by soldiers.

At the prison near the palace, in two rooms there were seven prisoners, five of them in irons. Allowance a good grosche a day, which is a little more than three halfpence.

The entrance to another prison was through a guard-room full of soldiers. In one room (twenty feet by ten) were twenty-six miserable objects, some sick on the dirt floor. In another room, not so bad, there were four.

In the prison in the new city there were a few women confined for debt, and a man and woman for theft: their allowance one good grosche a day.

A date on the front of a prison near the Vistula informed me it was rebuilt in 1769. There were eighty-one prisoners in it, whose beds were mattresses stuffed with straw. Most of them were employed in sawing wood and other occupations in the streets of the city for the inhabitants, who get their labour at one-third less than the expense of other labourers; the public being at the same time eased of part of the expense of supporting them.

In the suburbs is the zugth-hus, or spin-house, improperly so called, many of the miserable wretches seeming to have nothing to do. Some, however, were employed; and their allowance for working from six in the morning to seven at night, with two hours' rest at noon, was two grosche (3¼d.) each per day, which went to the keeper for feeding, or rather (as appeared by their looks) for starving them. The sick were lying on floors of dirt, without medical or any other assistance. This gave me so unfavourable an opinion of the police[1] of this country, that I could feel no inclination to visit the prisons in the provinces or (according to my constant practice in other places), to revisit those in the capital.

[1] Police = policy, in the sense of civil administration.